

Is generative AI impact on the environment really so devastating?

Posted by u/diddiliopoloh • 0 points • 89 comments

It's a moral question that it's really bothering me. It's true that it's single handedly one of the most polluting and devastating technologies out there? That one generative image is tantamount to burning an acre of the Amazon Rainforest?

Comments

u/halloweenchicky • 1 points • 2026-03-10 15:07 UTC

The people with houses near data centers beg to differ... I've seen examples of power bills going up and water pressure reduced ect

u/Eon1ne_ • 1 points • 2026-01-16 07:29 UTC

I kinda wish I just never existed if all the art I created was just fucking useless. There's no proof people won't pick clankers over us. All humans want is efficiency

u/Pretty_Ant9911 • 1 points • 2026-01-14 22:01 UTC

it's not good but not as bad as people are making it out to be. We need to focus on the big issues like burning fossil fuels, and deforestation.

u/galacticwitch17 • 1 points • 2026-01-12 21:42 UTC

There seems to be an extremely anti-AI rhetoric on tik tok in the U.S. especially. Lots of people between the ages of 15-30 commenting the copy and paste stat about water consumption and hate commenting on creators who use AI, trying to cancel them. It's nuanced and fascinating, but there is something rubbing me the wrong way about this group think / black and white "AI is the most evil" mentality

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-11-19 21:19 UTC

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u/Least-Face-5086 • 1 points • 2025-10-11 07:46 UTC

Many things we do to the environment are damaging and destabilizing. AI is just another. Singling any one of them out and saying that it by itself is not so devastating may be true, but that will not improve our odds. When I look at what we're doing to the earth and to animals and therefore ultimately to ourselves, I think of the expression "death by a thousand cuts."

u/Earthgrri-64 • 1 points • 2025-08-23 01:28 UTC

Whatever 🙄

u/frolof123 • 1 points • 2025-08-08 10:52 UTC

I wonder what proof there is? I only hear discussion but I see no ACTUAL proof, just people saying "study says" which means nothing without proof.

u/ConversationSilly951 • 1 points • 2025-12-28 20:29 UTC

There's no proof AI isn't harmful. The data centers emit light all the time, they have smells and sounds that disturb residents. They emit radiation which may be harming people. And their site construction has led to residents dealing with dust clouds and increases in respiratory issues. AI is not necessary for human life. America just wants to lead the charge (like by opening up federal land) to send a message. If we don't, China will, right? But China cares nothing for human rights or human life and won't care if cancer sky rockets in their country.

u/mrohss • 1 points • 2025-06-23 19:46 UTC

I recently published this article touching on this and other topics on #AI that we should carefully consider and examine. I[The True Cost of AI: Ethics, Sustainability, and Copyright in Question] (<https://www.rockandart.org/ai-sustainability-ethics-copyright-impact/>).

I'm not anti-AI, but all great power needs great responsibility 😊